

## 32T ENGL – 2022

### English – Solved

#### SECTION-A (Reading Skill: 10 Marks)

**(a) Write two reasons for the difficulty of reading on a train in long distance travelling. [2]**

Ans: Reading on a train is difficult because the monotonous rhythm of the wheels clicking on the rails soon lulls a passenger to sleep, and because train compartments get cramped and stuffy, making it hard to concentrate.

**(b) What are the two disadvantages of travelling by sea? [2]**

Ans: If the sea is rough, one is likely to get sea-sick, making it the worst form of transport; also, even in ideal weather, sea journeys take a long time, using up much of one's holiday.

**(c) Write two disadvantages of travelling by air. [2]**

Ans: Aeroplanes have a reputation for being dangerous, which intimidates even experienced travellers; besides, air travel is the most expensive form of transport.

**(d) Why does the writer dislike long car journeys? [2]**

Ans: The writer dislikes long car journeys because it is almost impossible even to read during them, and most of the journey is spent on narrow, bumpy roads crowded with traffic rather than smooth motorways.

**(e) Find a word in the passage which means 'lacking fresh air or ventilation'. [1]**

Ans: Stuffy.

**(f) Give an antonym of 'narrow'. [1]**

Ans: Wide / broad.

#### SECTION-B (Advanced Writing Skills: 25 Marks)

**2. Notice for Inter-College Song and Dance Competition (50 words) [5]**

NOTICE An Inter-College Song and Dance Competition will be held next month in our college auditorium. Interested students from all departments are invited to register their names with the undersigned by the end of this week. Prizes await the winners. Don't miss this chance to showcase your talent! Arnab/Anamika President, Students' Union

**OR: Poster on COVID-19 safety measures (50 words) [5]**

Ans: A poster titled 'STAY SAFE FROM COVID-19' listing: wear a mask correctly at all times; maintain at least one metre distance; sanitize hands frequently; avoid crowded places; get vaccinated; cover mouth while coughing/sneezing. Slogan: 'Your Safety Is In Your Hands!'

**3. Report on the felicitation of Lovlina Borgohain (100-125 words) [10]**

Ans: OLYMPIC MEDALIST FELICITATED — Our school recently organized a special function to felicitate Lovlina Borgohain, the Olympic bronze medalist boxer, for her outstanding achievement on the world stage. The event began with a warm welcome and a garland ceremony, followed by speeches from the Principal and senior students praising her dedication and discipline. Lovlina shared her inspiring journey from a small town in Assam to the Olympic podium, urging students to pursue their dreams with hard work and perseverance. She was presented with a memento by the school as a token of respect. The event concluded with a vibrant cultural performance, leaving students motivated to work towards their own goals.

**OR: Report on the plastic bag ban being ignored (100-125 words) [10]**

Ans: PLASTIC BAN IGNORED, ENVIRONMENT SUFFERS — Despite the state government's ban on plastic bags, the rule continues to be openly flouted across markets and shops. A visit to local markets revealed vendors freely using thin plastic bags for vegetables, groceries and other items, with little fear of penalty. Discarded plastic bags are seen choking drains, littering roadsides and being consumed by stray cattle, posing serious health and

environmental hazards. Shopkeepers claim the lack of affordable alternatives and weak enforcement are to blame. Environmentalists have urged authorities to strictly implement the ban and promote cloth or jute bags before the damage becomes irreversible.

#### **4. Application with resume for Computer Assistant post [10]**

Ans: A formal letter from Navanil/Navanita addressed to the Post-Master applying for the post of Computer Assistant advertised in the newspaper, mentioning qualifications and computer skills, followed by a detailed resume with personal details, education, and skills.

#### **OR: Letter to the editor on traffic rule violations [10]**

Ans: A formal letter from Selim/Surabhi to the Editor of 'The Sentinel' drawing attention to the frequent violation of traffic rules such as jumping signals, triple-riding and not wearing helmets in the locality, and requesting stricter enforcement and awareness drives.

## **SECTION-C (Grammar: 20 Marks)**

### **5. (a) "Why aren't you wearing shoes?" the teacher asks the girl. "My mother did not bring them down from the shelf," she answers simply. [2]**

Ans: The teacher asked the girl why she was not wearing shoes. She answered simply that her mother had not brought them down from the shelf.

### **(b) I asked my friend why he looked so sad. He replied that his father was seriously ill and there was little hope for his recovery. [2]**

Ans: I said to my friend, "Why do you look so sad?" He replied, "My father is seriously ill and there is little hope for his recovery."

### **6. Change the voice (any three) [3]**

Ans: (a) He bought his son a watch. → His son was bought a watch by him. (d) The blind man was being led by a little boy. → A little boy was leading the blind man. (e) The coach is training the players. → The players are being trained by the coach.

### **7. Correct tense forms (any five) [5]**

Ans: (a) She was talking to her neighbour when the baby began to cry. (b) I saw him a week ago. (c) If you had tried hard, you would have succeeded. (d) We reached the station after the train had left. (e) He is making a doll now.

### **8. Fill in with appropriate prepositions (any four) [4]**

Ans: (a) I am very much interested in your story. (b) The police ran after the thief. (c) He has no money with him. (d) She takes pride in her wealth.

### **9. Sentence transformation (any four) [4]**

Ans: (a) Is this the kind of dress to wear in school? → This is not the kind of dress to wear in school. (Assertive) (d) Atul is the best boy in the class. → Very few boys in the class are as good as Atul. (Positive) (e) I shall remember your kindness forever. → I shall never forget your kindness. (Negative) (g) On seeing the lion, he ran away. → He saw the lion and ran away. (Compound)

## **SECTION-D (Textbooks: 45 Marks)**

### **10.(a) 'Keeping Quiet' extract**

Ans: (i) The different kinds of wars mentioned are wars with gas and wars with fire. (ii) They achieve a victory with no survivors — a hollow, meaningless triumph. (iii) The warmongers should put on clean clothes and walk about with their brothers in the shade, doing nothing, i.e., give up war and live peacefully. (iv) The words meaning 'those left alive' and 'win' are 'survivors' and 'victory' respectively.

### **OR (b) 'A Roadside Stand' extract**

Ans: (i) The traffic passed with its mind fixed ahead, absorbed in reaching its own destination, without noticing the roadside stand. (ii) One turned out of sorts on seeing the landscape marred by the crude, artless paint of the roadside signboard. (iii) The two things sold at the stand were wild berries and crook-necked golden squash. (iv) If one wants to be mean, one should simply keep one's money and go along without stopping to help.

**11. Any three (30-40 words) [6]**

Ans: (i) Keats mentions dark spirits, gloomy days, an unhealthy and overdarkened way of life, and the dearth of noble natures as things that cause suffering and pain in the world. (ii) Kamala Das refers to her childhood fear of losing her mother; she hid it behind a brave, constant smile even while feeling deep anxiety inside. (iii) The parting words and smile signify the poet's attempt to hide her true fear and sadness beneath a calm, brave exterior, revealing the gap between her outer composure and inner turmoil. (iv) The 'sadness' the poet refers to is that human beings never fully understand themselves and constantly threaten their own existence through unnecessary violence and war.

**12. Any five (1 mark each)**

Ans: (a) M. Hamel taught in his school for forty years. (b) Mukesh lives in a small, dark room in a slum near the bangle-making basti in Firozabad. (c) Saheb looks for anything useful or saleable, sometimes even a coin, in the garbage dumps. (d) Gandhi and Shukla wanted to meet Rajendra Prasad in Patna. (e) Derek is Sophie's brother. (f) Sophie wants to have a boutique when she grows up. (g) 'Memories of a Chota Sahib' is taken from a memoir/anthology on Assam by a British official. (h) Gandhi visited Lucknow in 1916 to attend the Congress session.

**13. Any five (30-40 words each) [10]**

Ans: (a) The lesson we learn from 'The Last Lesson' is that we must value and take pride in our mother tongue, and never neglect learning it, for the freedom to use one's own language, once lost, can never be regained. (b) Geoff was a quiet, reserved and hardworking boy who worked at a slaughterhouse; he did not talk much but was dependable and mature for his age. (c) Jansie felt sad hearing Sophie's dream about Danny Casey because she knew it was an unrealistic fantasy and feared her friend was setting herself up for disappointment. (d) Gandhi was impressed with Shukla's persistence and sincerity, as he followed Gandhi from place to place—Lucknow, Cawnpore, his ashram—refusing to give up until Gandhi agreed to visit Champaran. (e) Professor Malkani's action was extraordinary because, at a time when supporting Gandhi invited government displeasure, he courageously and openly offered him shelter in his own house.

**14.(a) Atmosphere at school on the day of the last lesson (80-100 words) [5]**

Ans: On the day of the last lesson, the school wore an unusually solemn and quiet atmosphere. Instead of the customary noise and bustle before class, there was a great stillness, like a Sunday morning. M. Hamel was dressed in his best clothes, reserved for special days, and the back benches, usually empty, were filled with village elders who had come to attend this final French lesson out of respect and regret. Franz noticed that everyone, including M. Hamel, seemed unusually gentle and patient that day, and there was a heavy sadness hanging over the classroom as the reality of losing their language and school sank in.

**OR (b) Hazard of working in the glass bangles industry [5]**

Ans: Same as answered for the 2020 paper: workers labour in unhygienic, poorly lit conditions near hot furnaces, risking blindness, burns and respiratory disease, trapped across generations by poverty, debt and lack of organization.

**15.(a) Similarities between Bama and Zitkala-Sa (125-150 words) [7]**

Ans: (Same core answer as the 2020 solution): both authors faced discrimination in childhood—Bama through caste-based untouchability, Zitkala-Sa through the cultural erasure of Native American boarding schools—and both used their painful early experiences as the foundation for writing that exposes social injustice, showing resilience and gradually finding their own voice and identity despite oppressive systems around them.

**OR (b) Uruka celebration [7]**

Ans: (Same as 2020 answer): Uruka, the eve of Magh Bihu, involves community feasting at Bhelaghars built in the fields, bonfires, the building and burning of the Meji at dawn, and communal bonding through food, games and prayers for a prosperous harvest.

**16. Any four (30-40 words each) [8]**

Ans: (a) Astrologers foretold at the Tiger King's birth that he would one day be killed by a tiger, which set the course of his obsessive tiger-hunting life. (b) Dr. Sadao Hoki was a Japanese surgeon whose house stood on a hill overlooking the sea, with a private beach nearby. (c) Hana was Dr. Sadao's wife; she noticed a man crawling out of the mist on the beach, who turned out to be a wounded American prisoner. (d) The significance of Bhelaghar is that it is a temporary hut built by youths during Uruka using bamboo and hay, symbolizing togetherness and impermanence, and is ritually burnt the next morning.